07-12 第1篇

阅读理解（记叙文） The Handmade Lantern from Great-Grandma

The winter I was twelve, Great-Grandma Liu came to live with us for the Spring Festival. She was eighty-nine, small as a coat on a chair, and she spoke our dialect so quickly that I often caught only half of what she said. My room became her room for those three weeks. I slept on a small mattress in the living room. I was not happy about this at first.

On the second evening, Great-Grandma asked me for a piece of red paper, some bamboo sticks, glue, and a short candle. "Why?" I asked. She smiled and said nothing. She rolled up her old brown sleeves and began to work. Her fingers looked like tree roots — thin, bent, and strong. For two hours, she cut, folded, tied, and glued.

What came out of her hands was a small **lantern**. Its frame was bamboo. Its walls were red paper. On each side she had drawn, in black ink, a single Chinese character: 春 (spring), 和 (peace), 喜 (joy), 福 (luck). At the top, a thin **cord** was tied to a little bamboo hook. The lantern was simple — much simpler than the shiny plastic ones in the shopping centre. But it was the first one I had ever seen made by human hands.

"In my village, eighty years ago," she said, "we could not buy lanterns. So every child made one for the New Year. I made my first when I was your age." Then she added, quietly, "Tomorrow, I teach you."

The next day, I almost refused. I had plans with my classmates: a new movie at the mall. But Mum gave me one of her silent, firm looks, and I stayed. For three hours Great-Grandma taught me, slowly, in her thick dialect. I could not understand every word, but her hands were so clear — bend the bamboo here, press softly; too much glue will stain; paper must face the right way; candle flame must never touch the paper. I broke two frames before I made one that could stand. My fingers hurt. I felt **clumsy** and silly.

When I finally finished my own small lantern, it was ugly compared to hers. The corners were uneven. The ink on the character 春 was too wet and had smudged. I wanted to throw it away. Great-Grandma shook her head firmly. "Every first lantern is ugly. Every first lantern is **precious**."

On the night of New Year's Eve, our family walked to the **riverside** together. Along the path, people carried shining lanterns — bought in shops, of plastic and LED. I held mine in both hands like a small bird. A wind passed; our two lanterns, mine and Great-Grandma's, rocked side by side. Her flame was steady; mine flickered. A stranger called out to us: "What beautiful lanterns! Handmade, I can tell." Great-Grandma's face softened. I felt a warm wave under my coat.

Later that spring, Great-Grandma went back to her village. In the autumn, she died peacefully in her sleep. At her funeral, my mother gave me a small wooden box. Inside was her lantern — the steady one, the beautiful one. "She asked me to give you this," Mum said. "She also said: *Teach it to your own children one day.*"

Today, I am in high school. The lantern sits on my bookshelf, next to my old, ugly, smudged one. Every February, when the Spring Festival comes, I take them down, clean off the dust, and write a new small note to put inside the wooden box. "Great-Grandma, this year I tried to live like you: patient, quiet, strong." Some things, I am learning, are not made in a shop. They are made in a pair of old hands, and passed to a pair of young ones, candle to candle, until the last flame finds a new wick.

根据文章内容，选择最佳答案。

1. Why did the writer feel unhappy at first?

A. Because Great-Grandma had come to live with them.
B. Because she had to give up her own room and sleep in the living room.
C. Because she did not like red lanterns.
D. Because the writer had no new clothes.

2. What did Great-Grandma ask for on the second evening?

A. A movie ticket.
B. Red paper, bamboo sticks, glue, and a short candle.
C. A plastic lantern from the shop.
D. A bowl of hot soup.

3. Why did the writer's first lantern look ugly?

A. Because she rushed and used cheap materials.
B. Because the corners were uneven and the ink on the character 春 had smudged — it was her first try.
C. Because she had copied it from a website.
D. Because the candle burnt a hole in it.

4. What did Great-Grandma mean by saying "Every first lantern is precious"?

A. First lanterns are worth a lot of money.
B. First tries may look rough, but they are valuable because of the effort and love in them.
C. First lanterns can be sold for a high price.
D. Only the first lantern of the year will shine.

5. What is the main idea of the story?

A. Handmade lanterns last longer than plastic ones.
B. Handmade skills, care, and love can be passed from old hands to young ones — like a candle lighting a new wick.
C. Spring Festival is always cold and windy.
D. Great-Grandma did not know how to buy toys.

答案与解析

1.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"My room became her room... I slept on a small mattress..."
【解析】让出卧室导致不悦。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

2.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"red paper, some bamboo sticks, glue, and a short candle"
【解析】红纸+竹条+胶+蜡烛。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

3.
【答案】B
【题型】细节理解题
【定位】"corners were uneven... ink... smudged"
【解析】首次制作，技艺粗糙。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

4.
【答案】B
【题型】推理判断题
【定位】"Every first lantern is precious"
【解析】初次尝试虽拙却珍贵。A/C/D 均错。故选 B。

5.
【答案】B
【题型】主旨大意题
【定位】末段 "candle to candle..."
【解析】手艺与爱的代际传递。A/C/D 均偏离。故选 B。

词汇注释（超纲词）

- **mattress** [n.] 床垫
- **lantern** [n.] 灯笼
- **cord** [n.] 细绳

- **smudge** [v.] 弄污
- **wick** [n.] 灯芯